

AAA Tracker — Design System

Direction: "The instrument panel" — precision software for people who buy traffic.

A light, white-first surface, one cobalt signal colour, and monospace for anything numeric. Rebuilt October 2026 against the prevailing cloud-tracker SaaS convention, then made ours. Marketing site only ([site/](#)); the product UI is untouched.

1. The idea

A tracker's whole job is to make a number trustworthy. So the design behaves like instrumentation: **white surfaces, hairline rules, one signal colour, and tabular figures wherever a figure appears.** Colour is spent only on meaning — cobalt for the brand and the primary action, green for money made, red for money lost, amber for watch.

This replaces the previous "kept account book" direction. That version leaned on a warm paper ground, a serif display face and an italic accent word; it read as a print object, not as software, and it shared nothing with the category's visual grammar. The rebuild keeps the rigour and drops the metaphor.

Two typefaces carry it:

ROLE	FACE	USED FOR
Display / UI	Inter (variable 400–800)	h1 , h2 , nav, buttons, body, card titles
Data / labels	IBM Plex Mono (400/500/600)	eyebrows, table headers, KPIs, click ids, figures, footers

There is no third face and no serif. Anything that is a number, an identifier or a label is set in mono — that single rule is what makes the product screenshots read as real.

2. Identity

- Mark — "Route A"** ([site/assets/img/logo-mark.svg](#) , [favicon.svg](#) , [logo.svg](#)): a bold geometric **A** in a cobalt gradient tile. The apex node is the **click**; the two green base nodes are the **destinations**; the faint crossbar is the **attributed path** between them. It is name-native (A for AAA), product-native (a routed graph), and legible at 16px — tested at 96/64/48/32/24/16 before it shipped.
- Rejected concepts** live in [brand/route-2026/](#) with the comparison sheet at [brand/route-2026/concepts.png](#) : *b-crossbar-a* (a cut crossbar — bolder, more corporate, less meaningful) and *c-bars* (three ascending bars — clean but reads as a chart, not as the brand). Swap by copying one

over `logo-mark.svg`, `favicon.svg`, `logo.svg`, the inline SVG in all 11 pages, and updating `MARK` in `make_og.py`.

- **The triple motif:** three ascending bars (`.tri`) appear inside every section eyebrow and as the bullet rhythm. It is the "AAA" of AAA Tracker and it is the one decorative element permitted to repeat.
- **OG cards & icons:** regenerate with `python3 site/tools/make_og.py` (headless Chrome, real fonts; Pillow assembles `favicon.ico`). Run it after any headline or mark change.

3. Tokens

All in `site/assets/css/site.css` under `:root` . Never hardcode a value downstream.

Surfaces

TOKEN	VALUE	USE
<code>--surface</code>	<code>#ffffff</code>	page and card ground
<code>--surface-2</code>	<code>#f5f7fb</code>	tinted bands, app sidebar, table hover
<code>--surface-3</code>	<code>#eef2f9</code>	inert chips, meter tracks, active nav
<code>--surface-4</code>	<code>#e6ebf5</code>	dividers inside tinted areas
<code>--ink</code>	<code>#0a0d16</code>	dark bands, headings, the final CTA button
<code>--ink-2</code> / <code>--ink-3</code>	<code>#121826</code> / <code>#1c2436</code>	dark-band borders, dark hover

Text

TOKEN	VALUE	CONTRAST ON <code>--SURFACE</code>
<code>--text</code>	<code>#3a4252</code>	10.4:1
<code>--muted</code>	<code>#6b7280</code>	5.1:1
<code>--muted-2</code>	<code>#8b93a3</code>	3.4:1 — labels and axis text only, never body copy
<code>--on-ink</code>	<code>#f4f6fb</code>	on <code>--ink</code>
<code>--on-ink-muted</code>	<code>#9aa5bd</code>	7.6:1 on <code>--ink</code>

Lines

`--line` `#e4e9f2` (default rule) · `--line-2` `#eff2f8` (inside tables and cards) · `--line-ink` `#232c40` (on dark).

Signal

TOKEN	VALUE	MEANING
<code>--brand</code>	<code>#1f4bf0</code>	brand, primary action, active tab
<code>--brand-600</code> / <code>--brand-700</code>	<code>#1a3fd4</code> / <code>#1430a8</code>	hover / text-on-tint
<code>--brand-soft</code> / <code>--brand-soft-2</code>	<code>#eef3ff</code> / <code>#dfe8ff</code>	tints, eyebrows, chips
<code>--violet</code>	<code>#7a3dff</code>	the second accent : the interactive word in a headline ("click") and the reticle that lands on it. 5.3:1 on <code>--surface</code> . <code>--violet-soft</code> / <code>--violet-glow</code> support it
<code>--pos</code> / <code>--pos-soft</code>	<code>#0f9d58</code> / <code>#e9f8f0</code>	revenue, captured, healthy
<code>--neg</code> / <code>--neg-soft</code>	<code>#d93a3a</code> / <code>#fdeeee</code>	blocked, rejected, negative ROI
<code>--warn</code> / <code>--warn-soft</code>	<code>#b8770a</code> / <code>#fdf3e2</code>	watch, filtered, degraded

Rule: **green and red are only ever used for money and status**, never for decoration. If a screen has no good/bad distinction, it has no green or red on it.

Shape, depth, space

- Radii: `--r-xs 6` · `--r-sm 9` · `--r-md 12` · `--r-lg 16` · `--r-xl 22` · `--r-2xl 28` · `--r-pill 999`
Buttons and eyebrows are pills. Panels are `--r-xl` . Bands are `--r-2xl` .
- Shadows: `--sh-1` (hairline lift) · `--sh-2` (cards, nav shell) · `--sh-3` (the hero product frame) · `--sh-brand` (primary buttons — cobalt-tinted, not grey).
- Space: `--s1...--s10` = 4, 8, 12, 16, 24, 32, 48, 64, 96, 128. Sections are 96px apart (`--s9`), tightened to 64 on small screens.
- Layout: `--max 1200` content, `--max-narrow 900` for prose, `--gutter 24` (20/18 on small).

4. Type scale

CLASS	SIZE	WEIGHT	TRACKING
<code>.display</code>	<code>clamp(2.5rem, 1.35rem + 4.6vw, 4.5rem)</code>	800	−0.035em
<code>.h2</code>	<code>clamp(1.9rem, 1.2rem + 2.6vw, 3rem)</code>	800	−0.03em
<code>.h3</code>	<code>clamp(1.3rem, 1.1rem + .8vw, 1.65rem)</code>	700	−0.02em
<code>.h4</code>	<code>1.0625rem</code>	700	−0.01em
<code>.lead</code>	<code>clamp(1.0625rem, 1rem + .35vw, 1.25rem)</code>	400	—
<code>.small</code> / <code>.tiny</code>	<code>.875rem</code> / <code>.8125rem</code>	400	—
<code>.mono</code>	<code>.8125rem</code>	400–500	−0.01em

Headings are tight and heavy; body is loose (1.6). The gap between the two is the hierarchy — there are no mid-weight display sizes competing. `.num` turns on tabular figures; every number in a table or KPI uses it.

5. Components

- `.nav-shell` — a floating pill header: white, blurred, `--r-lg`, 24px inset from the viewport edge. **It shrinks as you scroll and has no divider line.** A `--shrink` custom property runs 0 → 1 over the first 140px of scroll (set by the scroll handler) and drives the header's vertical padding (16 → 4px), the shell's inset (11 → 7px), the corner radius and the mark's scale (1 → 0.86). The backdrop fades in with the same variable; the shell's own border and shadow do the separating, so there is never a hard rule across the page. On ≤980px the links collapse into a bordered panel under the bar. The toggle is a true 44×44 tap target, sits **last** on small screens (logo → action → toggle), and carries a 24px glyph whose bars are 3.4→20.6 in a 24-unit box at 2.1 stroke — the first version rendered a 13px-wide, 1.6px-thin glyph and read as a speck. It has **no** `margin-left: auto`: `.header-actions` already has one, and two auto margins split the free space, which stranded the toggle in the middle of the bar rather than at its right edge.
- `.btn` — pill. `--primary` (cobalt, cobalt shadow) · `--ghost` (white + hairline) · `--dark` (ink, for use on the blue band) · `--onink` (translucent, on dark) · `--quiet` (text only). `--sm`, `--lg`, `--block` are modifiers.
- `.btn--cta` — the one attention treatment, reserved for the header's "Start free" and used exactly once per page. Two long, quiet animations: a sheen sweeping across the fill every 5.6s and a ring pulse every 3.2s. On hover both stop, the sweep speeds up, and the button lifts and scales 1.035. Suppressed entirely under `prefers-reduced-motion`.
- `.shot` — the product frame: 1px border, `--r-xl`, `--sh-3`, browser chrome bar (`__bar` with red/amber/green dots, a mono URL, and a `Sample data` tag).

- `.hero-demo` — the product, moving. The hero plays a 19-second product film (`site/assets/video/`, 1920×1080, ~2.4 MB, with a poster) where a static mockup used to sit. It is deliberately **not** wrapped in `.shot`: the footage carries its own window chrome and would be framed twice. It autoplays muted and looped, but **never** under `prefers-reduced-motion`, and it ships an explicit pause control because WCAG 2.2.2 covers motion that starts on its own and runs past five seconds — a muted autoplay video shows no browser controls to stop it. This is the single strongest anti-generic device on the site — show the product, don't describe it.
- `.band` — a tinted rounded panel. `--dark` (ink with cobalt/violet corner glow), `--blue` (cobalt with a white radial sheen), `--flush` (deeper padding). Never two dark bands in a row.
- `.band--bleed` — a dark band that starts as the inset rounded panel and grows to full-bleed as it travels up the viewport, so the section swallows the page as you read it. Mark the element `data-bleed`; the scroll handler sets `--expand` 0 → 1 as the band's top moves from 92% to 34% of the viewport height (smoothstepped), and expands width, cancels the negative side margins, drops the radius to 0 and grows the inline padding so the inner measure holds at ~1100px instead of sprawling. `--vw` is set to `documentElement.clientWidth` (not `100vw`, which includes the scrollbar and would overshoot). With JS off, or under `prefers-reduced-motion`, `--expand` stays 0 and it renders as the plain inset panel.
- `.card` / `.panel` — white, hairline, `--r-lg` / `--r-xl`. `.card__ico` is a 38px tinted icon square with `--v`, `--p`, `--w`, `--n` variants. **A `.card` inside `.band--dark` keeps light-surface text** (`h3` / `.h4` / `b` in `--ink`, `p` in `--muted`) — without that rule a white card on the ink band has a white heading and reads as empty.
- `.srcgrid` / `.src` — the source catalogue: an auto-fill grid of 196px tiles, each a 32px icon slot plus a bold name. `.src__ico` holds the real brand mark; `.src__ico--mono` is a brand-initial monogram for the companies that publish no logo we may use, and `.src__ico--dark` puts a light mark (Snapchat's yellow) on an ink tile.
- `.tabs` / `.tabpane` — segmented control, `aria-selected`, arrow-key navigation, `paneIn` entrance. Used once, on the home page, to carry four mechanism mockups.
- `.compare` — a bad/good pair (red-tinted vs green-tinted) with `.compare__row` pills and a `.meter` score. The canonical "what you have vs what you'd get" device.
- `.dtable` / `.dtable-wrap` — the marketing-side data table: mono uppercase headers, hairline rows, `.r` right-align, `.name` bold first cell, `.yes` / `.no`.
- `.checks` — green tick list (`.checks--onink` on dark). `.numlist` — auto-numbered steps via CSS counters.
- `.meter` — 7px pill track with `.meter__fill` (`--good`, `--bad`, `--warn`), width set from `data-meter` when it scrolls into view so the fill animates.
- `.logostrip` — masked infinite marquee, pauses on hover, disabled under `prefers-reduced-motion`. `.orbs` — the integration logo field: 52–76px discs with brand SVGs, a 78–112px `--center` tile carrying the AAA mark on a cobalt ring, gentle float animation. `.orb--dark` gives a light brand

mark an ink tile — Snapchat's yellow and Intercom's pale cyan are invisible on a white disc otherwise.

- `.status` — the uptime card: head, 36-bar `.uptime` chart, axis, 2×N service grid.
- `.plans` / `.plan` — pricing cards; `--featured` gets a cobalt ring and `--sh-3`; `.plan__quota` is a mono chip that deliberately does not stretch. `.plans--five` handles the pricing page's five plans: a 6-track grid where each card spans two, so three sit across and the last two centre beneath them (the whole grid collapses to one column below 900px).
- `.faq` — native `<details>`, chevron rotates, first item open.
- `.form` / `.field` — inputs are white with `--r-sm`; focus is a 3px cobalt ring.
- `.prose` — legal copy at 74ch, 1.7 line-height, cobalt bullets and underlined links.
- `.cta` — the closing blue band: heading left, buttons right, stacks below 800px.
- `.hero__glow` / `.hero__grid` — the hero atmosphere: a cobalt radial glow and a 64px grid, both masked to a soft ellipse. Decorative only, always `aria-hidden`. **The hero clips its axes separately** (`overflow-x: clip; overflow-y: visible`). It used to be `overflow: hidden`, which cut the glow off at the hero's top edge exactly where the gradient is brightest and left a hard horizontal seam across the page — a 38/765 step at that line, measured from a screenshot. The axes are now split so the glow is still contained sideways on narrow screens while the vertical axis stays open and both layers overshoot the section and fade out on their own.
- `.hero__click` / `.hero__target` / `.hero__ripple` — the word "click" and the reticle that lands on it. **It is deliberately not a mouse cursor**: a tracker's job is to *target* a click, so the mark is a reticle — a ring, four ticks and a centre dot — which also scales far better than a pointer glyph, whose detail turns to mush when blown up. 57px on desktop, 38px under 560px (at 390px a full 57px would be larger than the type it points at). Both the reticle and the ripple are parked just **clear of the word**, not over it, so the comma stays legible. Decorative and `aria-hidden`; the headline still reads "Every click, accounted for." to a screen reader. The punctuation sits **inside** `.hero__click`, because `display: inline-block` creates a line-break opportunity after the box and an outside comma orphans onto the next line.

6. Motion

One entrance curve everywhere: `cubic-bezier(.22,.7,.24,1)`.

- **Hero entrance** — the hero stack rises in once on load (opacity 0 → 1, translateY 16px → 0, 720ms), staggered 0/90/180/300/420ms down the eyebrow → h1 → lead → buttons → notes. It is above the fold, so it cannot wait for a scroll observer and runs purely in CSS.
- **The click loop** — a 5.6s cycle, deliberately the same period as the CTA's sheen so the page has one rhythm. The reticle travels in from the upper left, **locks** (overshoots to 1.16, settles to 1), **contracts** to 0.84 as the click lands, then springs back; at the same instant a violet wash sweeps left-to-right under the word and a ring leaves the reticle's centre (scale 0.4 → 3, opacity 0.5 → 0).

The word itself is violet **permanently** — it does not change colour during the loop, so the emphasis is constant and only the movement is periodic.

- `.reveal` — opacity 0 → 1, translateY 14px → 0, 600ms, fired by IntersectionObserver. Stagger with `data-d="1|2|3"` (70/140/210ms). Gated behind `html.js`, so the page is fully readable with JavaScript off.
- Counters (`data-count`) count up over 1100ms with a cubic ease-out, and format with thousands separators.
- Meters (`data-meter`) fill from 0 on entry.
- Tab panes fade and lift 8px over 350ms.
- The orb field floats $\pm 8\text{px}$ on staggered 7s loops; the logo marquee runs 42s linear.
- **Scroll-linked, not time-based:** the header shrink (`--shrink`) and the band expansion (`--expand`) are driven from one `requestAnimationFrame`-throttled scroll handler, so they track the finger exactly rather than easing behind it. The expansion applies a smoothstep to its raw progress so it starts and ends gently. Setting two custom properties per frame is the whole cost — no layout reads beyond one `getBoundingClientRect()` per band.
- **Everything above is disabled under** `prefers-reduced-motion: reduce` — reveals land in their final state, counters jump to their value, marquees and floats stop, the CTA's sheen and pulse are removed, and the expanding bands stay as static inset panels (the scroll handler is not even attached).

7. Accessibility

- Every interactive element has a visible `:focus-visible` ring (2px cobalt, 2px offset).
- `.skip-link` → `main#main` on all 11 pages.
- Header nav uses `aria-current="page"`; tabs use `role="tablist" / role="tab" / role="tabpanel"` with `aria-selected`, roving `tabindex`, and Arrow/Home/End keys.
- Decorative SVG carries `aria-hidden="true"`; the hero product frame carries a descriptive `role="img"` + `aria-label`; brand logos carry real `alt` text.
- Text contrast is $\geq 4.5:1$ for all body copy; `--muted-2` is restricted to labels.
- Colour is never the only signal — status always pairs a colour with a word.

8. Honesty rules for the marketing surface

These are binding, not stylistic:

1. **No fabricated social proof.** There are no testimonials, no customer logos and no star ratings on this site, because there are no customers to quote yet. The proof on the page is product proof: the demo film and the uptime card. When real quotes exist, build the section — the space is designed for it.

2. **Sample data is labelled.** Every mockup frame that shows invented numbers carries a `Sample data` tag in its chrome.
3. **Show, then tell.** A mechanism gets a table, a meter or a frame before it gets a paragraph.
4. **Numbers must reconcile.** The home-page campaign table's conversions, revenue, cost, profit, ROI and CPA are internally consistent; a table that does not add up is the fastest way to look fake.

9. Competitor reference

The rebuild took its structural grammar from the prevailing cloud-tracker SaaS convention, sampled directly rather than from memory: floating pill nav → centred display headline with a coloured key phrase → product screenshot in the hero → logo band → blue stat band → tinted capability panel → segmented tab control → dark integration band with a logo field → reliability card → dark Copilot panel → pricing teaser → FAQ → blue CTA → 5-column footer.

What we deliberately did differently: a single cobalt signal instead of Tailwind's blue-600, the triple-bar motif as a repeatable signature, the "Route A" mark instead of a chart arrow, and a lighter dark section count (three per page maximum).

10. Files

<code>site/assets/css/site.css</code>	the whole system (~1.09k lines, token-driven)
<code>site/assets/js/site.js</code>	nav, sticky header shrink, reveal, counters, meters, tabs, expanding bands, form
<code>site/assets/fonts/</code>	Inter + IBM Plex Mono (bundled woff2)
<code>backend/themes/default/css/</code>	the same system applied to the product; the token block at the top of <code>style.css</code> mirrors these values, and the same two faces are bundled under <code>css/fonts/</code>
<code>site/assets/img/brands/</code>	26 real brand SVGs (Simple Icons) for the logo wall
<code>site/assets/img/logo-mark.svg</code>	the mark; <code>favicon.svg</code> / <code>logo.svg</code> derive from it
<code>site/tools/make_og.py</code>	regenerates the 8 OG cards + all icons
<code>scripts/md-to-pdf.py</code>	dependency-free Markdown → PDF (this document)
<code>brand/route-2026/</code>	mark concepts + comparison sheet

Reviewing a defect someone reports from a screenshot — see the `screenshot-defect-triage` skill (`~/.agents/skills/`). It covers locating the file on the Desktop, the macOS narrow-no-break-space filename trap, reading Retina captures at full fidelity, and the measure → reproduce → fix → re-measure loop that produced the hero-seam fix above.